ScoreDate: The Market for Dating With Financial Compatibility

Nov 10, 2026 · @Eddie Meehan

Executive summary

- **The market is big and shifting toward intent.** Dating apps are a $6B+ global category, headed toward $8.9B by 2030. Growth is coming from apps for people who want a real relationship: Hinge grew 38% in 2024 while Match Group overall was flat and its payer count fell 5%.
- **Money is where relationships break.** Arguments about money are the strongest predictor of divorce (Kansas State University). Federal Reserve research found couples with the lowest credit scores are 2–3x more likely to split up.
- **Credit is a trusted proxy for responsibility.** Credit is how lenders judge whether someone keeps their commitments — FICO scores are used by 90% of top lenders. The same habits carry into relationships.
- **Singles want this but rarely ask.** 4 in 5 Americans say good credit is attractive, but only 4% talk about money before a first date. ScoreDate brings that up front with a verified credit band and matching on money values.
- **The opportunity.** In our base case, ScoreDate reaches about **$34M in annual revenue by Year 5** from 100,000 paying members, or 0.7% of Match's paying base. Our range runs from about $8M (conservative) to about $101M (upside).

The state of dating apps

Dating apps are a $6 billion-plus global business that has stopped growing at the top and started splitting by intent. Global dating app revenue passed $6 billion in 2024, with North America producing 50% of it (Business of Apps).

The category leader is flat. Match Group (Tinder, Hinge, Match.com) reported $3.49 billion of revenue for 2025, unchanged from 2024. Its paying users fell 5% to 14.2 million, while revenue per payer rose 5% to $20.09 a month.

The growth has moved to apps built around serious intent:

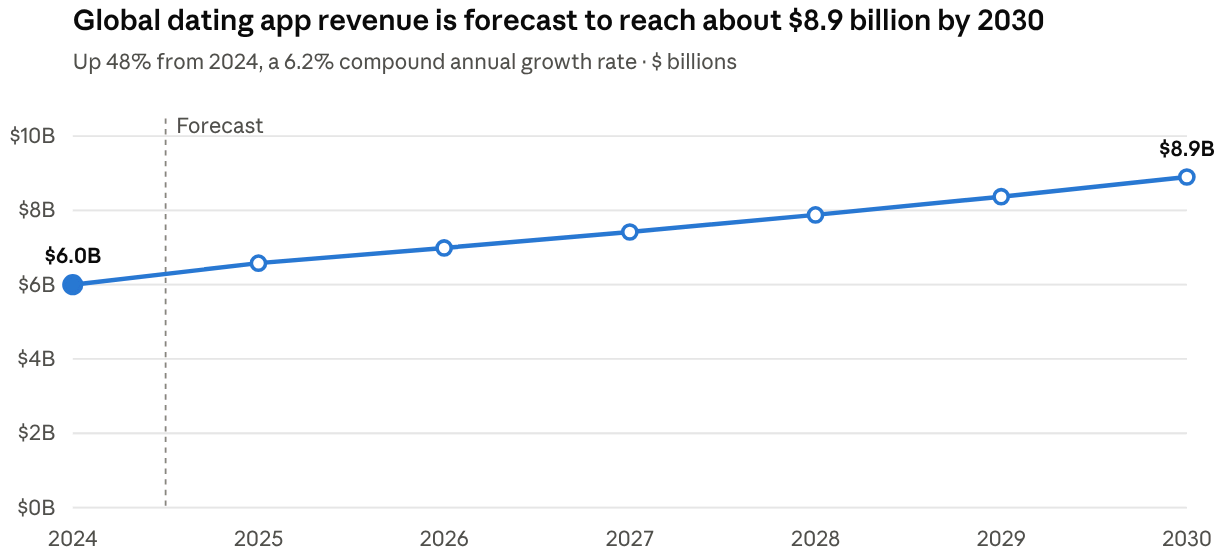
- Hinge, positioned as the app "designed to be deleted", made $550 million in 2024, up 38%, and grew direct revenue 26% year over year in Q4 2025 (Match Group).

- Swipe-first apps are losing payers: fewer people pay, but those who stay pay more. Users are tired of volume and willing to pay for quality.

That is the opening for ScoreDate: a smaller, verified, intent-first product that charges for better matches rather than more of them.

Five-year growth outlook

The market is expected to grow about 6 to 7% a year through 2030, adding close to $3 billion of annual revenue.



Business of Apps, 2025 Dating App Report: $6B+ in 2024, $8.9B by 2030 at 6.2% CAGR; years between are interpolated at that rate

A separate forecast puts online dating services growth at 6.9% a year from 2025 to 2030 (Research and Markets). The demand base is broad: 30% of US adults have used a dating site or app, rising to 53% of adults under 30, and one in five partnered adults under 30 met their partner online (Pew Research Center).

Growth is shifting from more users to more revenue per user. Match Group's revenue per payer rose 5% in 2025 while payers fell 5%, so the winners over the next five years will be the apps people pay more to use because the matches are better.

Money is where relationships break

Money conflict is the single strongest predictor of divorce, and no major dating app screens for it. The evidence:

Finding	Source
Arguments about money are "by far the top predictor of divorce", ahead of children, sex and in-laws, in longitudinal data on 4,500+ couples	Dew, Britt & Huston, Kansas State University, *Family Relations* (2012)
Money issues are the main reason for divorce in 18% of cases, third after incompatibility (44%) and infidelity (22%)	Institute for Divorce Financial Analysts, 2026 survey of CDFA professionals
Financial problems contribute to between 20% and 40% of divorces; 41% of Gen X divorcees name finances as the primary reason	Institute for Divorce Financial Analysts, citing 2025 data
41% of couples with consumer debt say money is what they argue about most, versus 25% of debt-free couples	Ramsey Solutions, survey of 1,072 US adults
63% of marriages start with debt; couples who fight about money carry about $30,000 of consumer debt on average	Ramsey Solutions

The gap is timing. Only 4% of singles discuss finances before a first meeting, and 56% wait until they have committed (Experian, 2024). By then, a mismatch is expensive to discover. ScoreDate moves that conversation to the start, gently and on the member's terms.

Why credit signals responsibility

A credit score is a track record of keeping promises, which is why lenders trust it with money and why it predicts relationships too.

How lenders use it. FICO Scores are used by 90% of top lenders to make billions of credit decisions a year (myFICO). A score from 300 to 850 sums up a person's credit history: whether they pay on time, how much they owe, how long they have managed credit, and how often they take on new debt. Lenders use it to decide who gets a mortgage, a car loan, a credit card or a line of cash, and at what price. It is the most widely used shorthand for "will this person do what they said they would?"

What it predicts in relationships. Federal Reserve economists studied a large panel of anonymized credit records and found the same signal at work in love (Dokko, Li & Hayes, Federal Reserve Board, 2015):

- People pair up with others whose credit scores are similar, even after accounting for income, education and other traits.
- Singles with the lowest scores are about 30% less likely to form a relationship in a given year than those with the highest (Brookings).
- Couples with the lowest average scores are two to three times more likely to separate than couples with the highest (Brookings).
- The authors conclude a credit score also reveals "relationship skill and level of commitment", not just money.

What singles say. 42% of Americans say knowing someone's credit score would affect their interest in dating them (Bankrate, 2017). Four in five Gen Z and millennial singles say good credit is attractive (Experian, 2024).

ScoreDate's position

ScoreDate is the first dating app built on the finding that financial compatibility predicts whether a relationship lasts. It turns that research into a product people actually want to use:

- **Credit bands, never scores.** Members show a band (Building, Solid, Strong or Elite), confirmed with a soft check that never affects their credit. ScoreDate never stores an exact score or a credit report.
- **Matched on money values.** Six questions (saver or spender, debt, who pays, joint or separate finances, five-year goals, investing style) feed the nightly Daily Drop, so people see shared values before they see a face.
- **Verified and invite-only.** Every member verifies their ID and photos. Membership opens neighborhood by neighborhood, starting in New York City, for people 25 and older.
- **Built to get people off the app.** Date planning, a safety share, calendar invites and post-date check-ins push matches toward real dates, the same intent-first model driving Hinge's growth.
- **Premium by design.** Membership ($24.99 a month), Premium ($49.99) and Reserve ($149, with a matchmaker) price ScoreDate above swipe apps, aimed at a user who already pays for quality.

The result is a self-selecting audience: people who are proud of how they handle money, and want a partner who is too.

Market size and revenue potential

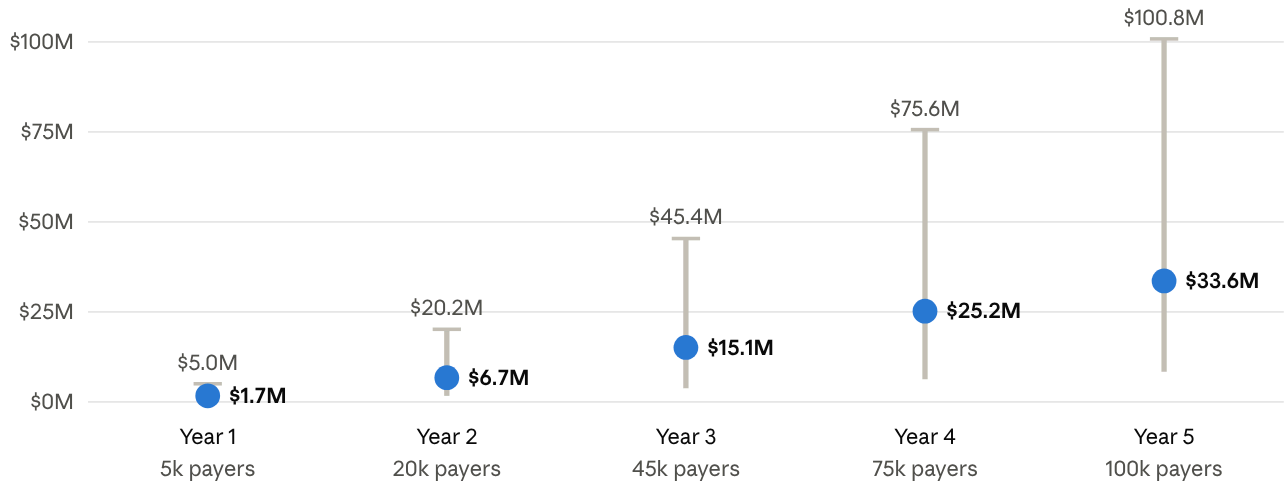
Total market. Dating apps took in more than $6B worldwide in 2024 and are on track for about $8.9B by 2030 (Business of Apps).

Our slice. North America is about half of that spend, or roughly $3B a year. Inside it, the fastest-growing part is apps built for people who want a real relationship. Hinge is the proof: $550M in 2024, up 38%, while Match Group as a whole stayed flat.

What ScoreDate could earn. The chart shows three paths. They all use the same assumed price mix (about $28 a month across memberships, Premium and add-ons) and differ only in how many people pay.

Base case reaches $34M a year by Year 5

Annual revenue at 100k paying members by Year 5, assuming $28/month blended ARPU ($336/year)
Dot = base case. Line runs from conservative (25% of base payers) to upside (3x base payers).



ScoreDate scenario model · payer counts and $28/month blended ARPU are planning assumptions, not results

The base case needs 100,000 paying members by Year 5. That is about 0.7% of Match Group's 14.2M payers today. Reaching it means winning a small, well-defined group — people who care about financial compatibility — rather than taking on the big apps head-to-head. Launching in New York, the largest US market for single professionals, keeps acquisition focused while the model is proven.

These figures are planning scenarios built on our own assumptions. They are not forecasts or guarantees.

Risks and how we manage them

Risk	How we manage it
Credit feels exclusionary or judgmental	Bands, not scores; a Building band is welcome and shown with its trend; members choose whether to show an Improving badge; matching weights shared money values, not wealth
Privacy and regulation (credit data, biometrics)	No exact scores or reports stored; soft checks only; written biometric consent; deletion on request; policies drafted for counsel review
App Store rules for dating and payments	In-app purchases through Apple, moderation of photos and video, report and block on every profile, 25+ age gate
Advertising limits on dating ads	Meta requires prior permission for dating ads; launch leans on referrals, Founding Members, events and organic social while approval is pending
Competition from Match Group and Bumble	A focused niche they cannot copy without alienating their mass-market users; verification and a financial-values identity build trust that is hard to replicate
Slow network growth in a new city	Neighborhood-by-neighborhood launch with waitlists, so every member opens to a dense pool on day one

Sources

- Business of Apps: global dating app revenues exceeded $6B (Aug 2025)
- Match Group: Q4 and full-year 2025 results (Feb 2026)
- Research and Markets via GlobeNewswire: online dating services to 2030 (Jun 2025)
- Pew Research Center: key findings about online dating in the US (Feb 2023)
- Kansas State University: money arguments and divorce, via ScienceDaily (Jul 2013)
- Institute for Divorce Financial Analysts: leading causes of divorce (Aug 2026)

- Ramsey Solutions: money, marriage and communication research
- Federal Reserve Board: Credit Scores and Committed Relationships, Dokko, Li & Hayes (Oct 2015)
- Brookings: how your credit score could predict the success of your relationship (Oct 2015)
- myFICO: what is a credit score
- Bankrate via PR Newswire: 42% of Americans say a credit score affects romantic interest (May 2017)
- Experian: dating and credit survey (Feb 2024)